Food Remedy API

Calorie Deficit Calculator by Oatsy – RE009

Prepared for: Food Remedy API Team

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Author: Jason Suhartanto

Introduction

The Oatsy Calorie Deficit Calculator, a health and fitness application developed by Starry Web Ltd, positions itself as a comprehensive solution for nutritional tracking and weight management. The application is widely accessible on both the Apple App Store and Google Play Store platforms. Its primary appeal lies in its promise to provide advanced calorie and nutrient tracking functionalities at no cost, a feature often monetised by its main competitors.

Key Insights

- **Extensive Free Features**: Oatsy offers a wide range of functionalities even within its free version. These include a detailed food diary, macro and micronutrient tracking, and a barcode scanning tool. Such features position the app as a strong competitor to other leading health applications, many of which limit similar tools to paid users.

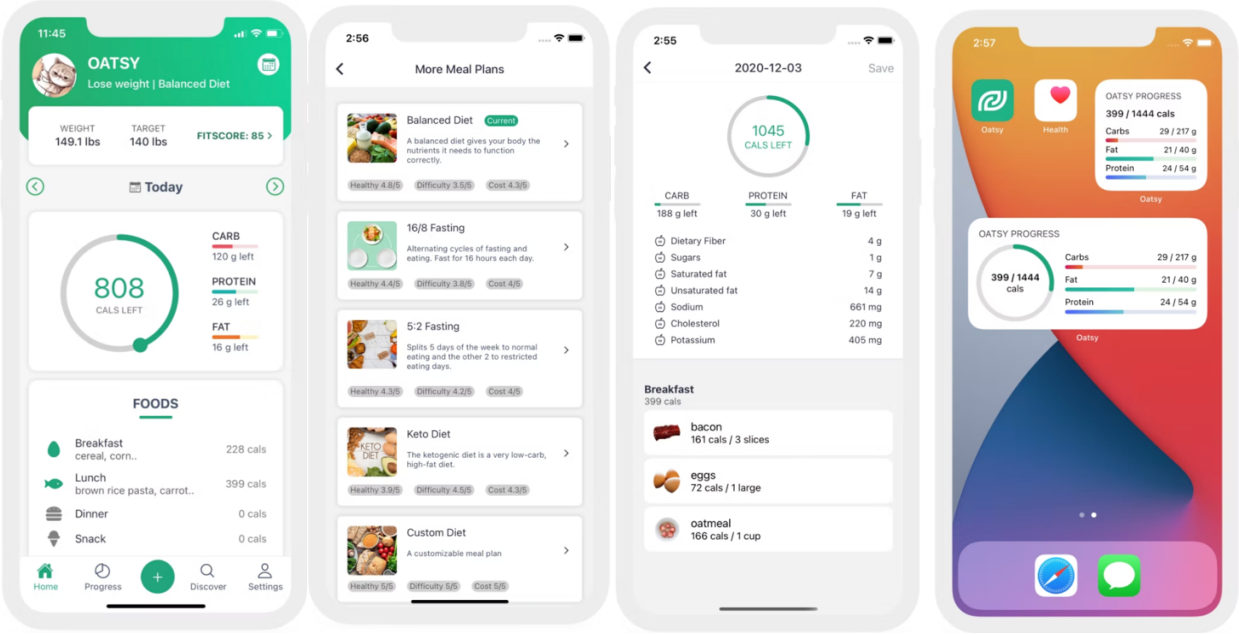
- **Ambiguous Freemium Approach**: Although Oatsy promotes itself as "completely free" and encourages users to "stop paying to count calories," the app adopts a freemium business model in practice. It provides a premium upgrade, "Oatsy Premium" which unlocks additional tools such as an AI-based food recognition scanner and in-depth daily health assessments. This suggests a contrast between the app's promotional language and its actual revenue strategy.

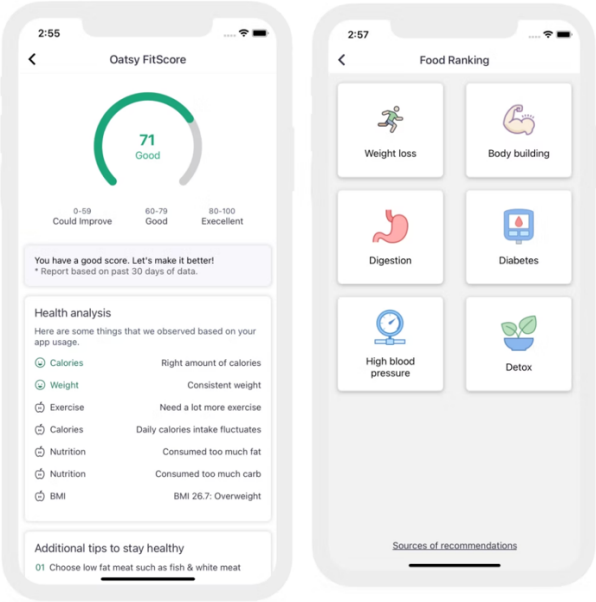
- **Clarified Company Identity**: There is potential for confusion regarding the app's development entity. While Oatsy is developed by Starry Web Ltd., based in Canada, other companies with similar names exist, such as OATSY'S ENTERPRISES LTD in the UK and Starry, Inc. in the United States. This report confirms that these entities are unrelated and that the app's developer operates independently.

- Divergent User Feedback: User reviews reveal mixed opinions. A large number of users praise the app for supporting effective weight loss and offering generous features at no cost. However, some express frustration over technical issues, such as frequent crashes and the need to restart the application. Others criticise the app's promotional tactics, describing the premium upgrade prompts as disruptive.

- Inconsistencies in Privacy Practices: There is a noticeable difference in how the app discloses its data privacy policies across platforms. The App Store listing states that user data is not linked to personal identity. In contrast, the Google Play Store entry suggests that personal and device identifiers may be collected and shared with third parties, raising concerns about data transparency.

Interface Overview





Core Product Features

Primary Functions:

- Food Diary: Offers an advanced diary backed by one of the largest, verified nutrition databases.
- Nutrient Tracking: Records both macronutrients (calories, protein, carbohydrates, fat) and micronutrients (sodium, fibre, cholesterol, potassium).
- Dietary Support: Accommodates specialised diets such as Balanced Dieting, Intermittent Fasting, and Keto.
- Hydration and Exercise: Includes daily water intake logging and exercise tracking, with options for custom workouts and integration with Apple Health.

Advanced Features:

- Barcode Scanner: Offers a free scanner for instant food logging, a feature usually paid for in competing applications.
- AI Food Scanner (Premium): Enables rapid food recognition through photographs, significantly reducing the time required for logging.
- FitScore and BMI Tools: Provides daily feedback on overall health, alerts for nutritional imbalances, and BMI tracking.
- Visual Analytics: Displays interactive graphs for calories, weight, and exercise trends.

UI/UX:

- Interface: Generally intuitive and easy to use, according to user feedback.
- Technical Issues: Some users report occasional crashes and delays in updating logged data.
- Integration: Synchronises with Apple Health and supports iOS widgets for quick nutritional insights.
- Branding vs Reality: Marketing highlights generous free features; however, advanced tools like the AI scanner remain premium-only, creating tension between brand messaging and actual practice.

User Feedbacks

Overall Ratings:

- Google Play: 3.8/5 (185 reviews).
- Apple App Store: highly positive but inconsistent ratings.

Positive Reviews:

- Users report significant weight loss (e.g., 20–45 pounds in six months).
- Praised for free features like the barcode scanner and food database.

Negative Reviews:

- Frequent complaints about app crashes and slow updates.
- Strong criticism of intrusive premium promotions, which some users find disruptive.

Conclusion from Feedback:

- Users value the effectiveness of the core product but are frustrated by technical instability and aggressive monetisation tactics.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the Oatsy application demonstrates strong functionality by providing an extensive set of free features that rival those of leading competitors. Its core tools, such as detailed nutritional tracking and a comprehensive food diary, are highly effective in supporting weight management. Nevertheless, the overall value is weakened by an aggressive freemium model, which creates a contradiction between its claim of being "completely free" and the reality of frequent premium promotions. The developer, Starry Web Ltd., is confirmed as an independent entity, which clarifies any confusion about corporate identity. User feedback reflects a divided experience: while many individuals report significant success in achieving their health goals, others express dissatisfaction with recurring technical problems and intrusive marketing strategies. Furthermore, discrepancies in the application's privacy policies across platforms raise important concerns about transparency in data handling. Overall, Oatsy represents a valuable tool for health management, but its long-term growth and user trust depend on resolving its inconsistencies in marketing, technical performance, and data protection practices.

References

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